

GALLERY OF COMPOSITION

COMPOSITION IS ALL ABOUT establishing an appropriate relationship between various elements of your painting, such as form, tone, and color, so that together they generate the meaning you want a painting to convey. When you establish the basic structure of a composition, ask yourself whether it communicates what you want to say about your subject, or whether changing the size, position, or structure of a particular feature will make your work clearer. In these paintings, each variation creates a different impact. A low viewpoint in one painting can cause isolated objects to appear dramatically bold and create a strong psychological effect, while a high viewpoint in another work allows individual elements to become part of a broader scheme that stretches away before the viewer in a leisurely, pleasing way.



Simon Ripley, *On the Edge* 17 x 14 in (43 x 36 cm)

Ripley's unusual composition places a vase on the far end of a table as if it is spinning off the edge. Large areas of orange-red complement the small active cool blue of the vase in this strange and evocative work.



Oskar Kokoschka, *Broad View of the Thames*, 1926

35 x 51 in (89 x 130 cm)

Kokoschka's painting is an excellent example of the way an artist can manipulate space within a composition in order to show more of the panorama than is possible with a conventional linear perspective. Here Kokoschka has utilized a form of curvilinear perspective, pushing the painting into an all-embracing circular composition. The artist's high viewpoint also allows more of the river and ground to be included in his panoramic sweep.